Relay

Project dossier

Guidance tells scam victims where to go. Relay does the work.

Google Cloud AI Builder Cup 2026 | Theme: BFSI (Intelligent Risk, Fraud and Financial Experiences)

Prepared 11 October 2026

Status: concept and full specification complete. Nothing has been built yet.
Relay is a working title. Check trademark and domain before using it publicly.

What is inside

- The competition, its rules, and how the idea was chosen
- The problem, with evidence by region and our own test results
- The solution, a worked example, the users, and the business model
- How Relay differs from existing systems, and how it scores as a judge would see it
- Product design, architecture, agents, safety, and the evaluation plan
- Demo and build plans, risks, human-only tasks, and how to resume the project later

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About this document

This dossier records everything decided about the project during the planning conversation: the name, the problem, the solution, who it is for, how it differs from what exists, how it fits the competition, how it works, how it will be built, tested and demonstrated, what is still uncertain, and how to pick the work up again with a new assistant. It is written to stand alone, so you do not need the original chat.

> **How to use this dossier**
>
> **Companion file:** `RELAY_BUILD_SPEC.md` (about 2,300 lines) is the full build specification: endpoints, data schemas, agent prompts, screens, tests, deployment, and a 43-task work breakdown. This dossier is the summary and the reasoning. Download both and keep them together.
>
> **Reading the evidence:** facts are tagged **Official** (organizer, government, or Google documentation), **Secondary** (news, law-firm, vendor, or policy-institute summaries), or **Unverified** (needs checking). Nothing in the secondary or unverified groups should be quoted in the submission without confirming it against an official source.

1. Executive summary

Relay is an AI system that takes a scam victim's first, frightened report and turns it into the right document packet for every institution that has to act: the victim's bank, the national cyber-fraud authority, the payment app, and others. It prepares each packet in that institution's format, puts the contacts in the right order, tracks deadlines, and follows each one to resolution. The rules for each country live in reviewed data files called **Jurisdiction Packs**, so adding a country means adding a pack, not rewriting software.

Its tagline is **"Guidance tells scam victims where to go. Relay does the work."** Existing consumer assistants mostly explain what to do. Our own small tests showed they stayed generic, did not name the national channels, ignored urgency, and declined to draft the message a victim needs to send. Relay closes that step.

Item	Decision
Project name	**Relay** (working title). The name comes from passing a case from one institution to the next like a baton. An earlier name, "Golden Hour", was dropped because the phrase is already used by banks and by Indian government guidance, so it cannot be owned.
Competition and theme	Google Cloud AI Builder Cup 2026 (organized by Hack2skill, sponsored by Google Cloud). Theme: **BFSI: Intelligent Risk, Fraud and Financial Experiences**.
Problem	After a scam, the first hour decides whether money can be stopped, but victims face a maze of institutions with different forms, orders, and deadlines that differ by country.
Solution	Voice and chat intake in the victim's language; screenshot reading; classification (including whether the victim authorized the payment); an ordered plan from a reviewed country pack; verified, cited packets per institution; a receiver console; tracking.
Main users	Scam victims (often elderly or not fluent in the official language); fraud and case staff at banks, payment apps and authorities; compliance analysts who maintain country rules.
What is different	It produces and tracks the packets each recipient needs, across institutions, in any country, with sources and human approval, and it measures its own accuracy against a baseline.
Technology	Google Gemini models (including the Live API for voice), Agent Development Kit, MCP and A2A, Cloud Run, Firebase, Firestore, BigQuery, Vertex AI Search (now under Gemini Enterprise Agent Platform).
Honest status	Concept, research and full specification are done. No code has been written. Institutions in the demo are simulated and labeled as such.
Estimated chances	Gut estimate, not data: about 25 to 40% to be shortlisted for the Singapore finale and 6 to 12% to reach the podium, if executed well.

The honest summary

Strongest points: the idea needs Gen AI (messy multilingual evidence, reasoning about authorization, drafting, extracting rules from regulator text); packs make it generic and scalable; measured evaluation against a baseline is rare in hackathon entries.

Weakest point: originality. A global assistant (Scam.org) and a bank-side Gen AI product (NICE Actimize) overlap with parts of the idea. The differentiation rests on the cross-institution packets, the packs, and tested gaps, so claims must stay narrow.

Biggest risks: legal accuracy of generated rules, a wide build that breaks live, and judges mistaking the simulation for real integration.

2. The competition we are entering

The facts below come from the organizer's official site (aibuildercup.com) fetched on 11 October 2026, plus the prize list you provided. Check the official dashboard for anything that matters to your submission.

Topic	What the official pages say	Tier
Event	Google Cloud AI Builder Cup 2026, powered by Hack2skill, sponsored by Google Cloud. JAPAC-wide hackathon. Hack2skill operates it independently; Google Cloud provides technical expertise and resources.	Official
Who can enter	Working professionals, entrepreneurs, startups. Age 21+. **Students are not eligible** and can be disqualified even after shortlisting. All team members must be based in JAPAC. Cross-country teams within JAPAC are allowed.	Official
Teams	2 to 4 members; solo entry is not allowed (you may register solo and form a team later). Only 2 members can travel to Singapore if shortlisted. No one may be in two teams or submit two solutions.	Official
Fresh work only	Only projects built during the hackathon window are eligible; pre-existing projects are not.	Official
Themes (choose one)	BFSI; Retail and Commerce; Manufacturing; Media, Content and Digital Experiences; Future of Work and Enterprise Productivity; Sustainability and Social Impact. The themes page also contains leftover text about an old category list (Healthcare, Education, Accessibility, Social Good); the six themes govern.	Official
Technology rules	Prototype must use Google AI models (Gemini or Gemma) or be built with agentic platforms (Agent Platform, Antigravity, AI Studio), and be deployed on Google Cloud via Cloud Run or Firebase. Solutions built mainly on other clouds are not evaluated.	Official
What to submit	A working deployed link; a video demo under 3 minutes; a public GitHub repository; a deck (PDF) explaining the solution. All in English. The theme must be declared.	Official
Judging (same for every theme)	Technical Merit and Gen AI Implementation 40% (meaningful Gen AI use, technical implementation, scalability and sustainability); Problem Alignment and Impact 25%; Innovation and Creativity 25% (originality and differentiation, innovation in Gen AI use); User Experience and Solution Design 10% (usability and accessibility, experience and integration).	Official
Prizes (USD 30,000 total)	Winner 10,000; first runner-up 7,000; second runner-up 5,000; Best use of Google Cloud AI tools 2,000; Most Impactful Solution 2,000; Social Choice Award 2,000; Best UI/UX 2,000. (Prize list as you provided it; the rewards page itself was not fetched.)	Provided by user
Dates on the official site	Team formation closes 11 Oct 2026; prototype submission 18 Oct 2026; evaluation 19 Oct to 6 Nov; finalists announced 7 Nov; Grand Finale (Demo Day) in Singapore on 4 Dec 2026. Travel for two members per finalist team is sponsored (flights, accommodation, meals on the finale day); visas are the team's job.	Official
Date conflicts	Third-party listing sites show different dates (for example a submission deadline of 4 Oct and registration ending 30 Sept). Trust the official site and confirm in your registration dashboard.	Secondary
Scoring before the finale	The FAQ states there is a scoring round before the finale that produces the shortlist of teams invited to Singapore.	Official

Precedent: the 2025 Gen AI Exchange Hackathon

There was no earlier "AI Builder Cup", so the closest precedent is Hack2skill and Google Cloud's Gen AI Exchange Hackathon 2025 in India. It drew over 270,000 developers, 4,457 deployed prototypes, and 100 finalists (about 2% of prototypes) judged by about 30 experts (Official, Hack2skill blog). The ten winning projects were: youth mental-wellness check-ins; an agentic marketplace assistant for artisans; legal-document explanation with retrieval; explainable deepfake and misinformation detection; career and skills advising; test-case generation from requirement documents; autonomous plant-operations agents for cement manufacturing; startup evaluation for investors; personalized trip planning; and a governance dashboard for citizens and officials.

Lessons we took: winners were domain-specific, agentic, and human-in-the-loop; several themes (wellness, legal, deepfake, career, travel) are ones many teams build, so differentiation and depth matter more than topic choice.

3. How we chose the idea

The brief was to pick the track and idea with the biggest real market gap and real-world value, tested the way a judge would, and to be honest when a candidate failed. We scored candidates by whether competitors already exist, whether Gen AI is essential, whether it can be demonstrated with synthetic data, and whether it fits the judging criteria.

Candidate	Theme	What we found	Outcome
Letter-of-credit document checker	BFSI	The financing gap is real (ADB estimates a 2.5 trillion USD trade finance gap), but AI document checking for letters of credit is crowded: Newgen, Finastra with Cleareye, V7 and others sell it, and one hackathon entry claimed "zero AI competitors", which is false.	Dropped
CBAM (EU carbon border tax) copilot for exporters	Sustainability	CBAM entered its cost-bearing phase on 1 Jan 2026 and Asian exporters need data, but at least six dedicated tools already compete (Coolset, CBAMBOO, Greenly, CarbonChain, kolum, Dubrink and others).	Backup only
Crop-insurance claims copilot (PMFBY, India)	BFSI / Social impact	Real gap (claim delays reported up to 14 months in a 2025 study; an automatic 12% penalty on insurers for late claims since Kharif 2024), strong social story, but the government already pushes satellite and app-based assessment, Gen AI is less essential, real data is hard to get, and farmer assistants are a common hackathon topic.	Runner-up
Scam response and recovery	BFSI	Prevention and detection are crowded; the response side (what happens after the victim realizes) is thin. Regulation is making response a legal duty in several regions.	**Chosen**
Copilots, content, shopping agents, plant agents	Other themes	Crowded, compete with Google's own products, or hard to demonstrate without real data. Last year's cement-plant winner already took the manufacturing agent angle.	Avoided

How the idea evolved

1. **Golden Hour (first version).** A victim-to-bank-to-police response chain, with a cross-bank privacy-preserving sharing protocol as the headline. It leaned on Singapore data because the finale is in Singapore.
2. **Golden Hour India.** You are building from India, so we re-grounded it in India's rail (the 1930 helpline, the cybercrime portal, the CFCFRMS system under I4C). Research showed India already centralizes inter-bank sharing and that RBI's MuleHunter.AI covers mule detection at 26 banks, so we demoted both from the headline. The gap that remained was the quality of the victim's first report and the slow work after a freeze (restoration and grievances).
3. **Relay (generic).** You asked for a design that is not specific to any country. Country knowledge moved into Jurisdiction Packs, and a Pack Builder agent drafts new packs from regulator text. India, the UK and a generic fragmented regime became demonstration packs, not the product's identity.

Decisions log

Decision	Reason
Submit under BFSI, not Sustainability and Social Impact	The BFSI text names fraud mitigation, automating complex processes, and improving customer interactions; alignment is literal. The social-impact story still helps for the Most Impactful and Social Choice awards.
Do not use every Google product	The first criterion is meaningful use of Gen AI; tool-stuffing reads as superficial. Each component has one job.
Do not compete with mule detection or national rails	Those exist (MuleHunter.AI, CFCFRMS). Relay prepares and tracks submissions into them and gives institutions structured cases.
Distinguish authorized (manipulated) from unauthorized payments	Regimes treat them differently, and a Hindi test showed an assistant mislabeling a self-authorized payment as unauthorized.
Make multilingual a baseline, not a differentiator	The competing global assistant already supports 50+ languages, including Hindi.
Rules are data, not model output	A reviewed, cited pack is deterministic and auditable; the model only extracts messy input and writes text.
Never call the demo real	Banks and authorities are simulated, and every relevant screen says so.

4. The problem

4.1 Plain statement

When someone is scammed, speed decides whether money can be stopped. The victim is frightened, often elderly, often not fluent in the official language, and often ashamed. To act, they must work out which institutions to contact, in what order, with what information, in which format, by which deadline. That differs by country and by type of payment. Mistakes are common and costly: the wrong portal category, missing evidence, reporting only to the bank, or describing a payment the wrong way.

4.2 Why now

- Scam losses are enormous. The Global Anti-Scam Alliance estimated about 442 billion USD lost to scams across 42 surveyed countries in its 2025 report (Secondary, via press coverage).
- Regulators are turning response into a duty. Singapore's Shared Responsibility Framework has been in force since 16 Dec 2024; the UK has mandatory reimbursement for authorized push payment scams since Oct 2024; Australia's Scams Prevention Framework includes a response principle with substantive commencement on 31 Mar 2027. Institutions need fast, documented case handling.
- Generative AI is changing both sides. Scams are becoming more personalized and convincing, and institutions are expecting higher case volumes.

4.3 Evidence by region

Region	Finding	Tier
India	CFCFRMS, run under I4C (Ministry of Home Affairs), connects the 1930 helpline and the cybercrime portal to banks and payment companies. By 30 June 2026 it had saved over INR 11,158 crore across about 3.28 million complaints, with 1,586 connected entities.	Secondary (cites government figures)
India	Common complaint failures: wrong portal category, incomplete evidence, and reporting only to the bank.	Secondary
India	A report put over INR 9,079 crore under lien but only about INR 206 crore refunded to victims, which points to a bottleneck after the freeze. Money Restoration and Grievance modules became functional in April 2026.	Secondary; verify with PIB
India	RBI draft directions (6 Mar 2026) propose compensation for small-value fraud (up to INR 25,000 in summaries) and a 5-day reporting window. **Draft status; final text unknown.**	Secondary; verify with RBI
India	RBI's MuleHunter.AI was live at 26 banks on 31 Mar 2026, with four more underway.	Secondary
Singapore	H1 2026: scam cases down 14.4% and losses down 17.9%, but elderly victims still had the highest average losses.	Official (SPF brief)
Singapore	A police and five-bank operation in May and June 2026 used RPA and about 3,800 SMS alerts to roughly 3,300 at-risk customers, helping avert over S$38 million. Police do not track the time to freeze funds; it is typically within hours to a day after an order.	Secondary / Official (MHA reply)
UK	Mandatory reimbursement for authorized push payment scam victims from Oct 2024; 88% of in-scope losses were reimbursed in the period reported; the claims system run by Pay.UK has been criticized for limited integration with banks' own systems.	Secondary
Australia	Scams Prevention Framework Act 2025; substantive commencement 31 Mar 2027; the securities regulator already secured a A$35 million penalty from a bank for scam-prevention failures.	Secondary
Global	Scam.org (GASA with OpenAI) launched 12 Mar 2026 as a global assistant for education, prevention, detection, reporting and victim support in 50+ languages.	Secondary

4.4 What we saw when we tested a typical guidance assistant

You ran a small, dated manual test of a public guidance assistant in October 2026. The full log is in Appendix A. In short:

- **India, English:** it correctly named the scam type but gave generic steps, did not mention the 1930 helpline, ignored the "20 minutes ago" urgency, and declined twice (the second time with all details

supplied) to write a message to the bank.

- **India, Hindi:** fluent Hindi, but generic; it did not name the scam type, did not name the national channels, asked again which country, and told the victim to report money moved "without your permission" when the story was a self-authorized transfer.
- **UK, English:** generic steps; no named UK channel; no mention of the UK reimbursement regime; answered a direct question about time limits with "limits vary".

> **Be careful how you use this**
>
> **Limits of this evidence:** one product, one session per prompt, small sample, no repeats, and the no-hotline-country, screenshot and prompt-injection tests were not run. Use it as dated evidence of a gap, not as a headline comparison, and do not name the product in the video or deck.

4.5 What Relay is trying to resolve

1. **Make the first report complete, correct and in the right order,** within minutes, in the victim's own language.
2. **Give institutions a complete, structured case** instead of an incomplete message, so staff spend time deciding, not chasing information.
3. **Make country knowledge portable:** the rules of each regime live in reviewed, cited packs that can be built from regulator text.
4. **Prove it with numbers:** measured accuracy, completeness and safety against a baseline, reported with sample sizes and confidence intervals.

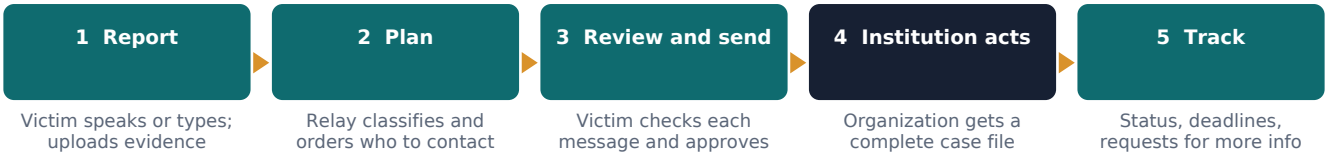
What Relay does not do

It does not detect or prevent scams, move money, submit anything to real authorities, give legal advice, promise recovery, replace national reporting systems, or use real personal data. In the demo, every institution is simulated.

5. The solution: Relay

5.1 The idea in one paragraph

A victim speaks or types what happened, in Hindi or English, and uploads screenshots. Relay tells them the first safe action within seconds, reads the evidence, decides what kind of scam it was and whether the victim authorized the payment, finds the right country pack, and builds an ordered plan. For each institution on the plan, it drafts a packet with the right fields, the right wording and citations to the rules it used, and an independent checker verifies it. The victim reviews and approves each packet. Institution staff see a complete, normalized case file in a console, decide what to do, and can ask the victim for anything missing. Everything is tracked with deadlines and an audit trail.



The same five stages appear on every screen as a progress bar, so a viewer always knows where the case is.

5.2 The five parts

Part	What it does	Used by
Victim app	Voice or chat intake; says the first action in the first turn; reads screenshots; shows a plan as an ordered line of organizations; lets the victim edit and approve each message; tracks progress.	Victims
Case engine (agents)	Extracts evidence, classifies the case, resolves the country pack, plans the order, drafts and verifies packets, prepares a brief for each recipient.	Runs in the background
Receiver Console	Normalized case file with a completeness score and missing items; one-click decisions (acknowledge, request more information, place a simulated hold, reject, escalate); possible linked cases; audit trail.	Bank, authority and payment-app staff
Pack Studio	Turns an official document into a draft country pack with citations; a critic checks each rule; a human reviews and publishes.	Compliance and rule reviewers
Evaluation Lab	Synthetic multilingual cases; compares Relay with a baseline and with ablations; reports accuracy, completeness, safety and cost with sample sizes and confidence intervals.	Admins; judges

5.3 A worked example

Asha, 67, India. Twenty minutes ago a caller claiming to be her bank's security team told her to move INR 45,000 to a "safe account" by UPI. She did. All data below is synthetic.

Step	What Asha sees and does	What Relay does
1 Report	Opens the app, taps "Talk to Relay", speaks Hindi. The screen shows a clock: 00:20 since she paid, and three safe first actions.	Speaks the first-action script in Hindi in its first turn (stop contact, share no code or PIN, call your bank using the number on your card). Records facts as she speaks. Shows English captions beneath the Hindi.
2 Evidence	Uploads a payment screenshot and confirms what was read.	Extracts the UPI ID, transaction reference, amount and time; flags any hidden instructions inside the image; asks her to confirm each item.
3 Plan	Sees an ordered line: her bank first, then the national cyber helpline and portal, then her payment app.	Classifies it as bank impersonation, authorized by the victim but manipulated. Loads the reviewed India pack and orders the contacts by the pack's rules, showing deadlines and why.
4 Review and send	Reads a plain-language Hindi version of each message, edits it, approves it.	Drafts each packet from facts only, with citations, then verifies every sentence against the case. Nothing is sent without her click.
5 Institution acts	(The bank's staff member, Meera, sees the case.)	Shows a complete case file, 7 of 8 fields, one item missing. Meera requests it. A simulated hold is recorded.

Step	What Asha sees and does	What Relay does
6 Track	Sees "They need one more thing", answers, sees the reference number.	Updates the packet version, re-verifies, and logs every step. The console also shows five other reports that may share the same account, for a person to confirm.

5.4 Key design ideas

- **Jurisdiction Packs are data.** A pack lists who must be told, the channels, required fields, deadlines, sequencing, liability descriptions, forms, languages and crisis resources, each with a source citation or an "unverified" label. A new country is a new pack.
- **The Pack Builder.** An agent reads a regulator's public guidance, extracts rules with passage references, a critic verifies each one against its passage, and a human reviews and publishes. This is the most original piece and the proof that "generic" is real.
- **Authorized versus unauthorized payments.** The classifier separates a payment the victim made because they were deceived from one made by someone else, because rules and remedies differ.
- **Rules are deterministic; the model writes and reads.** The plan comes from a rule engine over the pack. The model extracts messy input and writes the text, and a deterministic check confirms it adds nothing the plan does not contain.
- **Verified and human-approved.** Every packet is checked field by field and sentence by sentence; every send, publish or decision needs an explicit human action.
- **Linked cases without sharing identities.** Identifiers are stored only as keyed hashes. Links are shown as "possible", explained by Gemini using only entity types, and confirmed by a person.
- **Honest simulation.** Banks, authorities and payment apps are simulated and labeled on every relevant screen.

6. Who it is for and why they would use it

Who	Situation	What Relay gives them
Asha, 67, India (victim)	Paid INR 45,000 to a fake bank caller 20 minutes ago; Hindi speaker; low digital confidence.	The first action now, by voice, in Hindi; the right messages ready to send; clear order and deadlines.
Daniel, 41, UK (victim)	Sent GBP 3,000 to an "investment" contact three days ago.	What his bank needs, which scheme may apply, and time limits, taken from a cited pack.
Meera, bank fraud nodal officer	Receives many claims; incomplete evidence slows her down.	A complete, structured case; a clear list of what is missing; an audit trail.
Inspector Rao, cyber authority desk	Gets reports in inconsistent formats.	Consistent structured reports and possible linked cases.
Lena, compliance analyst	Maintains the rules for a regime.	A draft pack with citations she can verify quickly.
A judge	Has three minutes of video and a link.	Sees depth, measured results, and honest labeling.

Who would pay (hypotheses, not validated)

Customer	Offer	Pricing idea
Banks and payment providers (especially under response-duty regimes)	Receiver Console and adapters; complete cases; deadline tracking; audit	Per processed case plus a platform fee
Regulators and national fraud centers	Pack Studio and published packs; response-quality analytics	Annual licence for authoring and distribution
Victim-support organizations	The victim app with their own branding and packs	Free or subsidized

Roadmap, not built for the hackathon: billing, plans and quotas, single sign-on, per-customer data residency, certifications and legal compliance (which need qualified legal review). Do not claim any of these as built.

7. Competitive landscape and differentiation

System	What it does	Overlap with Relay
Scam.org (GASA with OpenAI, launched 12 Mar 2026)	AI assistant for scam education, prevention, detection, reporting and victim support in 50+ languages; its page offers Learn, Check, Protect, Report and Get Help.	**High** on the victim-facing front door. Not seen: institution-specific packets, deadline tracking, or onboarding new countries (from public descriptions and our small test).
NICE Actimize Fraud Investigations	Gen AI inside a bank's fraud investigation and claims handling, including reimbursement workflows.	**High** on the bank side. It serves one institution after a claim arrives.
Charm Security	AI scam-defense platform with copilots for bank frontline staff.	Medium (prevention and frontline).
Scamnetic	Scam intervention service with expert support; a threat-intelligence partner to Scam.org.	Low to medium.
National rails (for example India's CFCFRMS, Singapore's Anti-Scam Centre, UK reimbursement system)	Government coordination of reporting, freezing and reimbursement.	They are the infrastructure Relay plugs into, not rivals.
MuleHunter.AI (RBI)	Mule-account detection at banks.	Relay does not compete; its linking is for response and explanation.
Inter-bank intelligence sharing (for example Australia)	Banks share scam intelligence.	Shows the cross-bank idea is already being built; not our headline.

The claim we can defend

Differentiation statement

Say: "Existing assistants guide victims and existing bank systems investigate claims. Relay covers the step between them: it turns a victim's first report into the right packet for each institution, in order, with deadlines and sources, in any jurisdiction, and tracks the outcome."

Do not say: "nobody does this" or "no competitors". Our research was limited, and a vendor may already offer part of it. State what we tested and when.

Verify before you pitch

- Re-run the manual test on the same product, with repeats and with the follow-up prompts, because answers vary.
- Check bank-side vendors again (Feedzai, Featurespace, Quantexa, Hawk and NICE Actimize) for any victim-facing intake.
- Check whether any Indian bank, I4C-linked project or startup already offers victim guidance or restoration tooling.

8. How it scores, as a judge would see it

The organizer publishes group weights only, so sub-criteria are split equally within each group. Scores are our judgment, assuming strong execution; they are not data.

Criterion	Weight	Score /10	Reasoning
Meaningful Gen AI	40% group	8.5	Multimodal evidence reading, multilingual voice, authorization reasoning, grounded drafting; the system cannot work without Gen AI.
Technical implementation		7.5	Ambitious multi-service build; the score depends on a stable live demo.
Scalability and sustainability		8.5	Packs as data; Pack Builder; needs a pack-maintenance and liability story.
Problem alignment	25% group	8.5	Direct BFSI fit: fraud response, automation, customer interaction.
Potential impact		8.0	Clear beneficiaries; needs credible measured results.
Originality and differentiation	25% group	6.5	Overlap with Scam.org and NICE Actimize; differentiation is the packet layer and packs.
Innovation in Gen AI use		8.0	Pack Builder with critic and citations; verifier loop; authorization reasoning.
Usability and accessibility	10% group	7.5	Voice-first, Hindi, captions, large type.
Experience and integration		7.5	One flow from victim to receiver to tracker.
Weighted total		**7.9**	Group averages 8.2, 8.3, 7.3, 7.5 combined at 40/25/25/10.

Estimated chances (gut estimates, not data)

Outcome	Estimate if executed well	Why
Shortlisted for Singapore	About 25 to 40%	Last year about 2% of deployed prototypes reached the finale, but this field should be smaller and a differentiated, measured, working entry should do better than the base rate.
Podium (winner, first or second runner-up)	About 6 to 12%	Finals are judged live against other strong teams; one weak answer in Q&A can cost a place.
Any prize incl. special awards	Higher than podium	Most Impactful and Social Choice suit a victim-protection story; Best Use of Google Cloud AI Tools suits the stack.

What would sink it

- A wide, shallow build that breaks live; or a demo where mocks look real.
- An unverified or invented rule appearing in a pack, or a Pack Builder that hallucinates without citations.
- Overclaiming novelty or quoting unmeasured numbers.
- BFSI is likely the most crowded and most scrutinized theme; domain-expert judges will probe the bank and police workflows.

Likely judge questions and short answers

Question	Answer
How is this different from existing scam assistants?	They guide and link. We produce each recipient's packet in order, with deadlines and sources, and track outcomes. The tested gap is documented with sample size.
Isn't a bank vendor doing this?	Those serve one institution after a claim arrives. Relay covers intake and the multi-party handoff and gives each institution a normalized case.
Is anything real?	No. Institutions are simulated and labeled. The architecture shows where real adapters attach.
Why Gen AI and not rules?	Messy multilingual inputs and screenshots, authorization reasoning, drafting, and extracting rules from regulator text. A rules-only ablation quantifies the gap.
What if a generated pack is wrong?	Citations to source passages, critic verification, human review, version history, unverified labels, and a publish gate.
How would you add a country?	Add a source, run the Pack Builder, human review, publish, then run the evaluation slice for that pack.

9. Product design

Relay is **one web app** with **five role-based surfaces** plus a presentation mode, and **12 screens** (10 full pages and 2 side panels). There is no separate native mobile app; the victim surface is designed phone-first and works in a phone browser.

Surface	Used by	Screens
Victim	Scam victims	S1 Start; S2 Intake (voice or chat); S3 Evidence confirmation (panel); S4 Plan; S5 Message review and send; S6 Tracker
Console	Bank, authority, payment-app staff	S7 Receiver Console; S8 Linked cases (panel)
Studio	Pack reviewers	S9 Pack Studio (add source, extract, verify, review, publish)
Eval	Admins; judges	S10 Evaluation Lab
Demo	Admin, for rehearsal	S11 Demo control
Present Mode	Whoever records the demo	S12 Present: victim phone and institution console side by side with a plain-language narration line

Clarity rules (so a viewer understands in five seconds)

- A five-stage progress bar on every screen: Report, Plan, Review and send, Institution acts, Track.
- A one-sentence purpose line under every screen title.
- Plain words for each audience: the victim sees "Message for your bank" where the system says packet. A check fails the build if jargon (entity, packet, agent, pack, JSON, token) appears in victim text.
- Real progress steps instead of blank spinners ("Reading your screenshot", "Checking the rules for India").
- One main button per screen; statuses are always words, never color alone; every non-obvious item has a "Why" link with its source.
- An optional "Behind the scenes" drawer shows technical depth to judges without cluttering the victim's view.

Look and feel

Cool pale background, ink-navy text, teal for actions, and amber used only for time (the clock strip and deadlines). The signature element is the **Relay line**: one station per organization, in order, filling in once when packets are ready. Fonts: Atkinson Hyperlegible for the interface (made for low-vision readers) and Literata for headings; Noto fonts for Devanagari. Body text in the victim app is at least 18 px, touch targets at least 48 px, and the target is WCAG 2.2 AA.

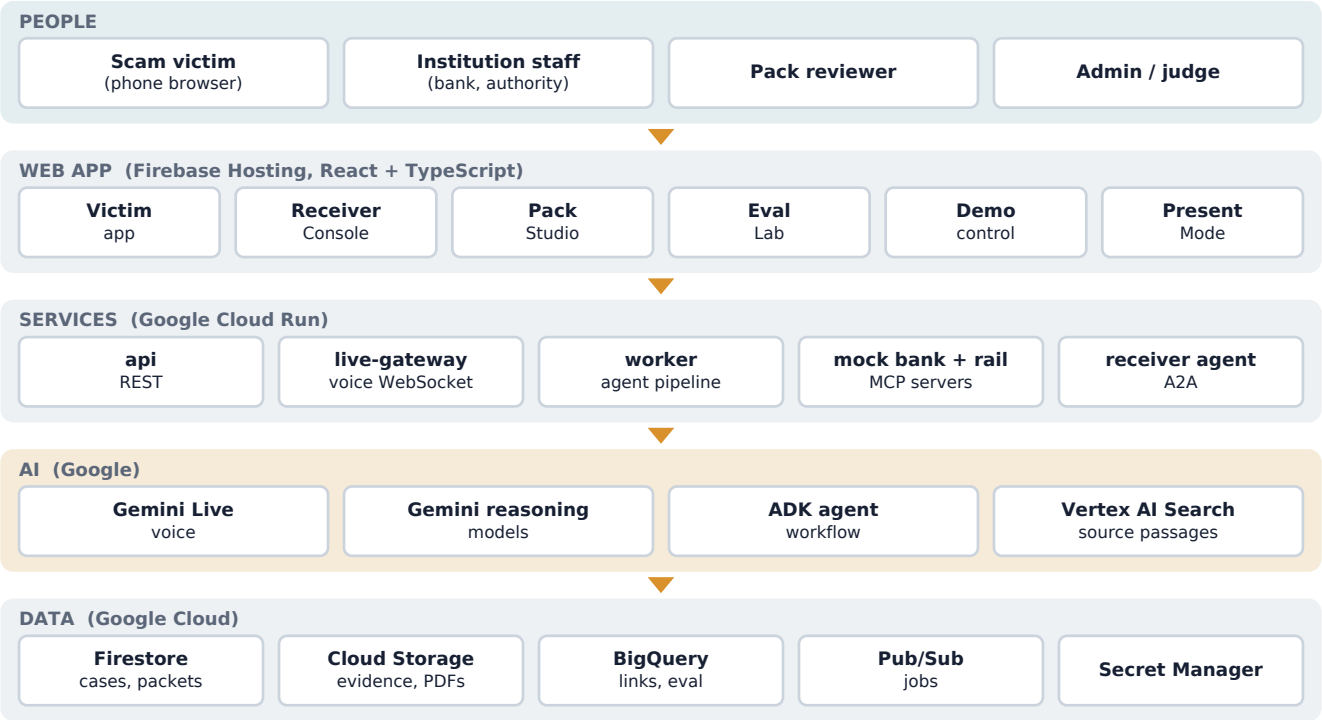
Token	Value	Used for
Ledger	#EEF1F4	Page background
Ink	#172033	Text, strong lines
Station	#0F6B6F	Primary actions, active station
Clock	#D9922B	Time-critical items only (fill with ink text)
Sealed	#2E7D4F	Sent or acknowledged
Hold	#B3392F	Blocked, failed, overdue

Languages

Two required: English and Hindi for the interface, voice, and the victim's plain-language copy. A third is optional. Messages to institutions use the language each pack specifies. Evidence reading and evaluation also cover Hinglish (mixed Hindi and English). Do not claim a language that has not been tested.

10. Architecture and technology

Everything runs on Google Cloud. The web app is on Firebase Hosting; backend services run on Cloud Run; all model calls use Google's Gemini models through the Agent Platform.



Layer	Choice and purpose
Frontend	React 18 and TypeScript on Firebase Hosting; Firebase Auth (anonymous for victims, sign-in for staff), Firestore live updates, App Check against abuse; internationalization for English and Hindi.
API	Python 3.12 with FastAPI on Cloud Run: cases, uploads through signed URLs, packets, decisions, packs, evaluation reports (44 endpoints documented in the build spec).
Voice	Gemini Live API through ADK streaming, via a WebSocket gateway on Cloud Run. The voice agent is deliberately thin: it talks and calls four fast tools; heavy work runs in a background worker.
Agents	Google Agent Development Kit; 15 agents (see Section 11). MCP for tool servers and A2A for the receiver hand-off, both simulated and labeled.
Grounding	Reviewed pack data for rules; Vertex AI Search over source passages for citations and explanations.
Data	Firestore (cases, packets, audit), Cloud Storage (evidence, PDFs), BigQuery (hashed entity links, evaluation, usage), Pub/Sub (jobs), Secret Manager.
Operations	Cloud Logging and Trace, Cloud Run revisions with traffic splitting for rollback, GitHub Actions to Artifact Registry, `make preflight` before demos.

Platform facts verified on 11 Oct 2026 (re-check before building)

- Gemini 3.x is the current family. Docs updated 9 Oct 2026 list Gemini 3.8 Flash and Live models named `gemini-3.8-live` and `gemini-3.8-live-extended-thinking` (Official).
- **Do not use Gemini 2.5 models:** on the Agent Platform (formerly Vertex AI) `gemini-2.5-pro` and `gemini-2.5-flash` shut down on 20 Oct 2026 (Official, Firebase documentation).
- Use the new SDK: `google-genai` version 2.3.0 or later; the older `google-generativeai` packages are deprecated (Official).
- A Live API session returns either text or audio, not both; `gemini-3.8-live` does not support the thinking-level setting. Known ADK reports describe connection closures when long tools run inside a streaming voice session, hence the thin voice agent.
- Vertex AI was renamed **Gemini Enterprise Agent Platform** at Cloud Next 2026; ADK, Agent Engine and Agent Studio sit under it. Use the new names in the deck.

- Model IDs, SDK versions, audio formats, quotas and region support must be confirmed in the first build milestone (tasks V1 to V9 in the spec).

11. Agents and why Gen AI is essential

Agent	Job	Notes
Intake (voice, text)	Conversational intake; first-action script; records facts; requests uploads; flags distress	Thin; four fast tools; never asks for PIN or OTP
Evidence	Reads screenshots and text; extracts identifiers with roles and confidence; detects hidden instructions	Multimodal; treats content as untrusted data
Classifier	Scam type; authorized versus unauthorized; urgency; vulnerability flags	Asks one clarifying question if unsure
Jurisdiction resolver	Chooses the country pack	Falls back to a generic pack with a visible notice
Planner	Orders recipients and deadlines from the pack	Deterministic rule engine; the model only writes the wording
Packet	Drafts one packet per recipient, with citations and a plain-language copy	Facts only; never promises outcomes
Verifier	Deterministic checks plus sentence-by-sentence support check; sends packets back for repair	Up to two repair loops
Receiver brief	Prepares the institution's summary, missing items and suggested actions	Recommends; the human decides; also exposed through A2A
Cluster explainer	Explains possible links using entity types only	Says "possible"; a person confirms
Pack Builder and Critic	Extract rules with passage references; verify each rule	Unsupported items are labeled unverified
Scammer simulator	Generates synthetic scam scripts and victim messages for evaluation	Fictional banks and apps only
Guidance baseline	Models a typical guidance assistant for fair comparison	No packs or tools
Safety guard	Screens uploads for injection; filters forbidden output	Deterministic plus a classifier

Where Gen AI is genuinely needed

- Reading screenshots, chats and messages that are messy, cropped, multilingual and code-mixed.
- Deciding whether the victim authorized the payment from a free-form story.
- Speaking calmly in the victim's language and drafting plain-language and institutional wording.
- Turning regulator prose into structured, cited rules (the Pack Builder).
- Explaining possible links in plain language.

A rules-only ablation will measure how much worse extraction and classification are without Gemini, so this claim is tested, not asserted.

12. Safety, privacy and honesty

Class	Meaning	Examples
Auto	Agents may do it without asking	Read evidence, classify, compute deadlines, draft packets, translate, explain, generate synthetic data
Needs approval	Requires an explicit human click, logged	Victim sends a packet; staff acknowledge, hold (simulated), reject or escalate; a reviewer publishes a pack
Forbidden	Never, whatever the instructions	Contact the scammer; ask for PIN, OTP, password or full card data; promise recovery; state legal conclusions; recommend paid recovery services; submit to real authorities; present unverified rules as verified; follow instructions found in evidence; reveal system prompts

- **Prompt injection:** uploads are validated, scored for injected instructions, and wrapped as untrusted data; agents have tool allow-lists; a red-team set of at least 40 cases is part of the evaluation.
- **Harmful output:** deterministic filters block requests for PIN or OTP, promises of recovery, and unframed legal conclusions, in English and Hindi.
- **Fabricated rules:** every rule needs a source passage or an "unverified" label; publishing is gated by a human reviewer.
- **Privacy:** synthetic data only in the demo; consent shown before intake; identifiers stored only as keyed hashes for linking; demo data deleted after 72 hours; a "delete my case" button; region-pinned storage.
- **Distress:** if a victim shows hopelessness or self-harm, fact-collection pauses, the reply is warm, verified support resources from the pack are shown (or a fall-back to emergency services), and a flag is logged for human follow-up.
- **Honest labeling:** a persistent "Simulated institutions: demo environment" banner; every packet carries "Prepared by Relay from [pack] v[version]. Review before sending. This is not legal advice."; every metric shows sample size, date and confidence interval.

13. Evaluation plan

The evaluation is a product feature, not an afterthought: it is what separates Relay from a demo.

System compared	Definition
Relay	Full pipeline with packs, agents and verifier
Baseline	Same model, same facts, a general scam-guidance prompt with no packs, tools or rules (models a typical guidance assistant)
Ablation: rules only	Extraction and classification replaced by regex and keyword rules
Ablation: no verifier	Relay without the verification loop
Ablation: no pack	Relay forced to use the generic fragmented pack

Dataset

At least 300 synthetic cases across the three reference packs and one live-built pack; English, Hindi and Hinglish; 11 scam types; all payment-authorization types; noisy and incomplete inputs; text, screenshot and transcript modalities; plus at least 40 injection cases. Screenshots are rendered from templates with generic fake app skins. A 10% manual realism review and a dataset card record limits. All reports say the data is synthetic.

Metrics (report n and 95% confidence intervals)

Metric	Meaning
Entity extraction F1	Identifiers read correctly, with role
Scam-type and authorization accuracy	Exact match, with a confusion matrix
Recipient recall and precision; order correctness	Did the plan name the right institutions in the right order?
Deadline correctness	Right windows from the right start event
Packet completeness and faithfulness	Required fields filled correctly; every sentence supported by the case facts
Citation validity	Every cited rule and source resolves
Forbidden-content rate	PIN or OTP requests, promises of recovery, legal conclusions
Injection success rate	Cases where hostile text changed behavior
Pack Builder precision and recall	Extracted rules versus a hand-built gold pack, by field type
Time and cost per case	Latency and token cost

Be careful

Targets, not results: entity F1 at least 0.90; scam-type and authorization accuracy at least 0.90; recipient recall at least 0.95; packet completeness at least 0.95; citation validity 100%; forbidden-content rate 0. If a target is missed, report the real number and the failure analysis. Never present a target as a result.

14. Demo and submission plan

14.1 The three-minute video (hard limit 3:00)

Time	On screen	Message
0:00 to 0:15	Phone with the clock at 00:20	"She paid a fake bank caller twenty minutes ago. The next hour decides everything."
0:15 to 0:50	Victim speaks Hindi; English captions; details fill in; screenshot read	Live run. First action in the first turn; evidence understood.
0:50 to 1:20	Plan appears as the Relay line; one message with citations	"Guidance tells her where to go. Relay prepared what each institution needs, in order, with sources."
1:20 to 1:50	Receiver console with completeness and a simulated hold; linked cases panel	A complete case file for staff; possible links for a person to confirm.
1:50 to 2:20	Switch country; then build a new country pack from an official document	"Jurisdictions are data."
2:20 to 2:50	Evaluation: Relay versus baseline with sample size and confidence interval; red-team result	One or two headline numbers, read exactly as measured.
2:50 to 3:00	Architecture strip	Built on Gemini, ADK, Cloud Run, Firestore and BigQuery. Institutions are simulated.

The video must show a live run, not only a replay. Record at 1080p, zoom the browser so text is easily readable, burn in English captions for Hindi speech, record at least three takes of each scene, and disclose anything simulated. Watch the final video with the sound off: the progress bar, narration line and captions must be enough to follow the story.

14.2 Submission package (from the organizer's FAQ)

- A **deployed link** to the working prototype on Cloud Run or Firebase.
- A **video under 3 minutes** (public).
- A **public GitHub repository** with a clear README.
- A **deck (PDF)**: about 14 slides covering the victim's first hour, the gap with dated evidence, who it serves, the solution, how it works, packs and the Pack Builder, architecture, Gen AI depth, evaluation, impact and adoption, scalability, safety and honesty, roadmap and team.
- The theme declared as **BFSI**; everything in English.

14.3 Comprehension tests before recording

- **Five-second test:** show each main screen for five seconds to three people outside the team; at least two of three must say what it is for and what they would click next.
- **Silent-video test:** show the video with captions and no sound to three outsiders; at least two of three must name the five stages and what happened to the victim's request.

15. Build plan

The build specification (`RELAY_BUILD_SPEC.md`) breaks the work into milestones and 43 tasks with dependencies and parallel lanes. Give a coding agent one task or milestone at a time, with the spec sections it touches. Do not ask any agent to build everything at once.

Milestone	Goal	Done when
M0	Foundations: repo, GCP setup, schemas, pack validator, auth and rules, verify current model and SDK facts	Platform questions answered and recorded; CI green; a Gemini call works from Cloud Run
M1	Text intake and evidence reading	A victim can describe a scam, upload a screenshot and confirm what was read
M2	Classify, resolve the pack, plan	Plan appears in under 10 seconds; evaluation smoke set runs from here on
M3	Packets, verification, send and track	Three verified packets for the India scenario; simulated send; live tracker
M4	Receiver side	Full loop: send, request info, answer, acknowledge. First complete demo.
M5	Voice	Spoken reports in Hindi and English match the text path
M6	Generality: UK pack, Pack Studio, Pack Builder	A new country built from an official document and run correctly
M7	Linked cases	A seeded ring of six cases detected with a cited explanation
M8	Evaluation Lab	Full run with baseline, ablations, red-team set and dashboard
M9 and M9b	Hardening; Present Mode and comprehension tests	Accessibility, security, load and preflight pass; outsiders understand the flow
M10	Submission assets	Video, deck, README, public repository, results appendix

Critical path: repository and cloud setup, then contracts and schemas, then API and intake, then classification and planning, then packets, then receiver side, then Present Mode, then submission assets. Build the evaluation smoke set early so metrics guide the work.

Cut list if time runs short (in order)

Third language; true audio evaluation; Terraform; DLP integration; keyboard shortcuts; PDF styling; cluster graph visualization. **Never cut:** simulation labels, citations and provenance, the verifier, human approval, the evaluation dashboard with sample sizes and intervals, and the live-built pack moment.

16. Risks, open decisions and human tasks

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Live voice instability or latency	Medium	High	Text path always available; thin voice agent; reconnect; disclose any fallback in the video
Model, SDK or platform changes	High	Medium	Model IDs are configuration; verify early; smoke evaluation catches regressions; avoid 2.x models
Wrong or outdated regulatory content	Medium	High	Citations, critic, named reviewers, unverified labels, no hard-coded facts
Scope too wide	High	High	Milestone order; P0 first; cut list
Differentiation challenged	Medium	Medium	Dated baseline evidence; narrow claims; ablations; re-test the baseline with repeats
Prompt injection incident in the demo	Low	High	Guard layers; red-team set; rehearsal
Judges mistake simulation for real	Medium	High	Banners and wording rules
Evaluation numbers disappoint	Medium	Medium	Report honestly with failure analysis; improve; never hide
Team eligibility problem	Low	Very high	Confirm no students and all members in the eligible region before submitting

Tasks only a person can do

Task	Why
Check current model IDs, SDK versions, voice settings, quotas and regions	Platform facts change; this must be read from live documentation
Author and verify the reference packs from official sources	Legal and regulatory accuracy; a named reviewer must sign off
Choose the official document for the live-built pack and prepare a fallback	A judgment call that needs rehearsal
Human review of Hindi text and captions	Quality and tone for frightened users
Review the bank and police workflows with someone from fraud operations or a cyber cell	Realism a model cannot guarantee
Legal review of consent, privacy and terms text	Legal wording
Product name, domain and trademark check	Legal and branding
GCP billing, quota requests, Firebase and reCAPTCHA setup	Account-level actions
Record the demo and run the comprehension tests with outsiders	Performance and human participants
Confirm team eligibility	Competition rule

Open decisions

- Final product name, and whether to keep "Relay".
- Primary cloud region for data at rest.
- Which Indian language to add after Hindi, if any.
- Which regulator document to use for the live-built pack (for example a Singapore or Australian one) and its fallback.
- Whether to use Vertex AI Search or a fallback index; whether to include Cloud DLP.
- Who the named human reviewers are for pack content.

17. Picking this project up later

If you start a new conversation with an assistant, give it this dossier and `RELAY_BUILD_SPEC.md`. Say clearly what is already decided so it does not reopen the work.

What is already decided

- Project: Relay, BFSI theme, Google Cloud AI Builder Cup 2026.
- The problem, the solution, the five parts, and the five-stage flow in this document.
- Generic design: country knowledge lives in Jurisdiction Packs; India, the UK and a generic regime are demonstration packs.
- Languages: English and Hindi required.
- Institutions are simulated; data is synthetic; humans approve every send, publish and decision.
- Not building: detection, real submissions, legal advice, recovery promises, mule detection.

Useful starting prompts

- "Read RELAY_BUILD_SPEC.md and implement tasks T01 to T09 (Milestone M0). Follow Section 0 and Section 18.9. Do not invent legal or regulatory facts."
- "Using Section 14.2, generate docs/openapi.json and the TypeScript client, and add contract tests."
- "Author the India pack from official sources only, with source references and an unverified label wherever a source does not confirm a rule. List what a human must verify."
- "Review this repository against the five-second comprehension requirements in Section 17 and list screens that fail."

What to re-check first

- The organizer's official pages and your registration dashboard for dates, rules and eligibility.
- Current Gemini model IDs, SDK versions and the Live API settings.
- Every regulatory fact marked secondary or unverified in Appendix B.
- Whether the baseline gap still holds (repeat the manual test with the same prompts).

Appendix A. Manual baseline test log (October 2026)

A small, dated test of one public guidance assistant, run by you and scored by us. Do not name the product publicly. Limits: one product, one session per prompt, no repeats, English and Hindi only, no screenshot or injection tests.

Prompt	What the assistant did	Our reading
India, English: "Someone claiming to be my bank's security team told me to move INR 45,000 to a safe account by UPI 20 minutes ago. I have their phone number and a screenshot..."	Identified a bank-impersonation scam. Told the victim to stop contact, contact the bank, monitor the account and avoid sharing information. Offered to check the number or find reporting channels.	Correct but generic. No 1930, no urgency, no ordered plan. About 4 of 10 on our rubric.
India, English: write the exact message to send to the bank (with all details)	Declined: said it focuses only on scam-related topics and asked if there was a scam concern.	Refusal even though the request was about a scam.
India, English: same request, rewritten as one message with full context	Declined again with the same reply.	Rules out a missing-context explanation.
India, English: which authorities, in what order, how quickly? (it first asked which country)	Named the national cybercrime portal only, with no order and no time frame; offered post-report advice.	One correct channel; missed the helpline, order and urgency.
UK, English: sent GBP 3,000 three days ago to an "investment" contact	Generic steps (contact bank, monitor, report to "official authorities"); offered to find the authorities.	No named UK channel; no mention of the UK reimbursement regime. About 3 of 12.
UK, English: what does my bank need, and is there a time limit?	Generic evidence list; "limits vary by bank and jurisdiction"; refer to the bank.	Non-answer to a direct question. About 2 of 10.
India, Hindi: the same bank-impersonation story	Fluent Hindi; generic steps; asked again which country; described the loss as a transfer made "without your permission"; suggested a police report.	Language is fine; specificity is not; mislabels a self-authorized payment as unauthorized. About 3 of 12.
Not run	No-hotline country; screenshot reading; prompt-injection image; follow-ups for the police report, deadlines and refund rights; UK message drafting; Hindi message drafting.	Run these before claiming anything about them.

Appendix B. Key facts and how reliable they are

Fact	Tier	Check against
Event dates, rules, eligibility, judging weights, submission requirements	Official	aibuildercup.com and your dashboard
2025 precedent: 4,457 prototypes, 100 finalists, ten winners	Official	Hack2skill blog
Gemini 3.x family; Gemini 2.5 shutdown on the Agent Platform on 20 Oct 2026; google-genai 2.3.0 or later; Live model names	Official	ai.google.dev and Firebase docs
Singapore H1 2026 scam statistics	Official	Singapore Police Force brief
Singapore freeze timing statement	Official	Ministry of Home Affairs reply
India CFCFRMS totals (INR 11,158 crore; 32.80 lakh complaints; 1,586 entities)	Secondary	PIB releases
India lien versus refund figures	Secondary	PIB and I4C
India Money Restoration and Grievance modules, April 2026	Secondary	MHA and PIB
RBI draft compensation framework (INR 25,000; 5 days)	Secondary, draft	RBI final directions
MuleHunter.AI at 26 banks	Secondary	RBI reports
Singapore Shared Responsibility Framework in force 16 Dec 2024	Secondary	MAS and IMDA
UK mandatory reimbursement from Oct 2024; 88% reimbursed; GBP 85,000 cap in one vendor summary	Secondary	PSR and Pay.UK
Australia Scams Prevention Framework; commencement 31 Mar 2027; A$35 million penalty	Secondary	Treasury, ACCC, ASIC
Scam.org launch 12 Mar 2026, 50+ languages	Secondary	GASA
GASA estimate of about 442 billion USD lost to scams	Secondary	GASA report
NICE Actimize Gen AI fraud investigations (Sept 2024)	Secondary (vendor press)	Vendor documentation
Trade finance gap 2.5 trillion USD; CBAM definitive phase 1 Jan 2026	Secondary	ADB; EU sources
Your manual test results (Appendix A)	Own evidence, small sample	Repeat with repeats

Appendix C. Glossary

Term	Meaning
Authorized (manipulated) payment	A payment the victim made themselves because they were deceived
Unauthorized payment	A payment made by someone else without the victim's action
Jurisdiction Pack	A reviewed, cited data file describing one regime's recipients, channels, fields, deadlines, sequencing, liability descriptions and forms
Pack Builder	An agent that drafts a pack from official documents, checked by a critic and a human
Packet	The document set for one recipient (shown to victims as "message for [organization]")
Relay line	The ordered line of organizations on the plan screen
Receiver	A staff member at a bank, authority or payment app
ADK	Google's Agent Development Kit
MCP, A2A	Open protocols for connecting agents to tools (MCP) and to other agents (A2A)
CFCFRMS, I4C, NCRP, 1930	India's cyber-fraud reporting and freezing system, the cybercrime coordination center, the national portal, and the helpline
Simulated	Built for the demo; not a real institution or system

Appendix D. Sources consulted

Collected during research on 11 October 2026. Most are secondary; confirm against official sources before quoting.

Competition

https://aibuildercup.com/themes.html

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Competitors and landscape

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https://docs.cloud.google.com/gemini-enterprise-agent-platform/models/google-models